

T U N E A B L E

THE MUSIC COMMONS

White Paper v0.1

Discover. Support. Champion. Participate.

A community-led digital music platform for displaying, discovering and supporting the music we love.

September 2026

A founding statement of purpose and direction

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Status: founding white paper. Future commitments and proposed limits remain subject to legal, operational and constitutional review.

1. Executive Summary

Tuneable is a community-led digital music platform built around a simple idea:

People should be able to publicly display, discover and support the music they love — and the value created by that activity should flow back into the musical community.

The modern internet gives us access to almost unlimited music, yet much of the infrastructure surrounding music remains organised around consumption.

Tuneable proposes a different model.

Rather than simply asking what people are listening to, Tuneable asks:

What music do people care enough about to champion?

Users can collect and display media they love, support it financially, compete to become its champion, discover music through places and communities, and collectively define the language through which music is described.

This creates a **digital media shelf**: a public expression of taste, appreciation and cultural identity.

Behind this social layer sits an economic system designed to move value toward creators, together with transparent ranking mechanisms, open-source ambitions and a long-term commitment to community governance.

Tuneable is established as a UK Community Interest Company.

Its ultimate ambition is not simply to become another successful technology company.

It is to become **community-owned infrastructure for the discovery, support and celebration of music.**

2. The Digital Media Shelf

The internet has largely transformed music collections from things we physically own into things we access.

Tuneable asks what happens if we bring back another aspect of the collection:

Display.

A record collection was once a physical representation of identity. The records on someone's shelf told you something about them. They demonstrated what they had discovered, what they valued and what they wanted other people to hear.

Tuneable is a **digital media shelf** for the networked world.

Users can build a public collection of the music and other media they value. But Tuneable goes further than a conventional playlist.

A Tuneable collection can show: - what someone loves; - what they have discovered; - what they support; - what they are currently championing; - what communities they belong to; - what places and scenes they are connected to.

The shelf therefore becomes simultaneously:

Collection + identity + recommendation + support.

The objective is not to maximise passive consumption. It is to make appreciation visible.

3. Championing Tunes

One of Tuneable's central concepts is the **Champion**.

A user can choose a piece of media they believe deserves greater recognition and become its champion.

Champions compete for recognition at different scales: - Global - National - Regional - City - Community - Party

A person might therefore be **Global Champion of a tune**, **Bristol Champion of a tune**, or simply the person who first championed an obscure track within their own community.

Championing can be influenced by support, discovery, participation and time. The precise mechanics can evolve, but the cultural idea is important:

Tuneable turns musical taste into something people can actively stand behind.

Instead of merely saying, "I like this," a user can effectively say: "**I'm backing this.**"

This creates a social game around discovery. A listener might discover something before everyone else. A DJ might champion an emerging artist. A local community might rally behind a tune. Thousands of people might eventually compete to demonstrate that they were among its earliest supporters.

In this way, Tuneable can make **being early** culturally valuable.

4. Location-Based Discovery

Music is inseparable from place.

Scenes emerge in cities. Genres develop around communities. Clubs create local cultures. Travellers discover music through the places they visit.

Tuneable therefore treats location not simply as metadata, but as a mechanism for discovery.

Discover music through places. Discover places through music.

A user might explore: - what is being championed in Marrakech; - what is emerging in Bristol; - what music defines a particular neighbourhood; - what artists are supported by a local scene; - what music is associated with a particular venue or event.

Conversely, music can become a way of discovering places. A tune can lead someone to a city. A chart can lead someone to a venue. A community can lead someone to a festival. A musical scene can become a reason to travel.

Tuneable should therefore allow discovery to move in both directions:

Place → music Music → place

This creates the possibility of a genuinely geographical layer of musical culture alongside global discovery.

5. Collective Tagging & The Musical Lexicon

Genres are useful. They are also imperfect.

Musical culture constantly creates new combinations, scenes and identities that do not fit comfortably inside existing categories.

Tuneable therefore proposes a more grassroots approach to musical classification. Users should be able to collectively tag the media they support. Over time, these tags can become a living musical lexicon.

A community might develop its own terminology. A scene might create a new category. A musical movement might acquire a name organically. A previously obscure combination of styles might become recognisable through collective use.

Rather than asking a central authority, “What genre is this?”, Tuneable can ask:

How does the community describe this?

The resulting taxonomy should be dynamic, participatory and capable of evolving beyond the limitations of established genre structures.

Tags can therefore become more than filters. They can become **cultural artefacts in their own right**.

6. The Music Economy

Tuneable connects cultural participation with economic support.

Users can voluntarily place financial value behind media they appreciate.

If people voluntarily put value behind music, more of that value should reach the people who create it.

Tuneable's current model allocates the majority of creator-directed tip revenue to artists and creators, while retaining a proportion to operate the platform. The long-term objective is to increase the creator share as Tuneable becomes more efficient and develops sustainable sources of revenue beyond creator-directed payments.

Tuneable should also remain inexpensive to participate in. A small contribution should still be meaningful.

The platform should ultimately operate within a **proposed maximum 10% platform commission** on creator-directed payments, with unavoidable third-party costs such as payment processing, taxes, refunds and chargebacks distinguished wherever practical.

This is intended as a long-term constitutional commitment rather than a claim about current economics.

The goal is not simply to create another revenue stream. It is to create a mechanism through which **community appreciation becomes creator value**.

7. Transparent, Open Infrastructure

A platform that influences culture and handles money should not be a black box.

Tuneable therefore intends to make transparency a structural principle.

Its existing architecture includes a central financial ledger recording transactions such as tips, refunds, wallet activity and payouts, together with sequencing, balance information and cryptographic integrity mechanisms.

Over time, Tuneable should make appropriate economic information publicly verifiable while protecting individual privacy.

Users should be able to understand: - where money goes; - how creator allocations work; - how rankings work; - how major governance decisions are made; - how the platform earns and spends money.

The same principle applies to technology. Tuneable intends to progressively open-source significant parts of its infrastructure and provide public APIs wherever practical.

Security-sensitive systems and private information may necessarily remain closed. But where technology can safely be inspected, reproduced or improved by the community:

We should open it.

8. A Community Music Network

Tuneable is not intended to replace existing music infrastructure. Streaming services, labels, distributors, DJs, radio stations, venues, festivals and music communities all perform valuable functions.

Tuneable sits around that ecosystem.

Discovery → support → identity → participation → community.

A listener can discover an artist. A DJ can champion them. A community can support them. A venue can build around them. A label can discover an emerging scene. An artist can see where their music is resonating. A traveller can discover a place through its music.

The result is intended to be a network in which different participants contribute different forms of value.

Music is not reduced to a transaction between an artist and a listener. It becomes a **network of relationships**.

9. Governance & The Music Commons

Tuneable is established as a UK Community Interest Company because it is intended to operate for community benefit rather than solely for private shareholder return.

But legal structure is only the beginning.

The long-term ambition is for meaningful governance to progressively move toward the communities that create and sustain Tuneable.

This should happen gradually: - **Founder stewardship**: build the infrastructure and protect the mission. - **Community participation**: create meaningful mechanisms for consultation, representation and proposals. - **Community treasury**: place an increasing proportion of appropriate surplus under community governance. - **Distributed governance**: move significant decisions toward community-controlled mechanisms. - **DAO or equivalent**: where legally, technically and practically appropriate, establish decentralised governance.

The objective is not to put everything on a blockchain. The objective is:

To give the people who create and sustain Tuneable meaningful ownership of its future.

Tuneable should ultimately behave more like a piece of **community infrastructure** than a conventional extractive technology company.

10. The Anti-Extraction Principle

Tuneable does not oppose wealth.

Artists should be able to become wealthy from their work. Developers should be well paid. Employees should prosper. Entrepreneurs should be rewarded for building useful infrastructure.

But Tuneable should not become a machine for extracting extraordinary private wealth from the community it serves.

We therefore intend to place constraints on executive remuneration, related-party transactions and excessive concentration of economic power.

One proposed framework is that no Tuneable Director should receive annual total compensation exceeding an **absolute ceiling of £1,000,000 per year**.

The precise figure and its implementation require legal and constitutional review before becoming binding.

The deeper principle is more important than the number:

Tuneable should reward contribution without turning control of community infrastructure into a path to extreme personal enrichment.

We are not trying to build another machine for manufacturing billionaires.

Likewise, Tuneable should not become a speculative financial instrument masquerading as a community. Any future tokenisation or decentralised finance mechanisms must remain subordinate to the musical and social purpose of the platform.

11. Measuring Success & Building the Commons

Tuneable should measure success differently from a conventional technology company.

Revenue and financial sustainability matter, but they are not sufficient measures.

Creator value - How much money reaches creators? - How many creators receive support? - How quickly are creators paid?

Discovery - How many new artists are discovered? - How effectively does Tuneable surface emerging music? - How geographically and culturally diverse is discovery?

Participation - How many people champion, support and curate music? - How many communities are active? - How many parties, events and local scenes participate?

Openness - How much infrastructure is open source? - How many people contribute? - How much public data and tooling exists?

Community benefit - How much surplus is returned to musical and cultural communities? - What educational, artistic and community initiatives are supported?

The ultimate question is not:

How much value does Tuneable capture?

It is:

How much musical value does Tuneable help circulate?

12. The Tuneable Covenant

Tuneable is a platform, but it is also an experiment in building a different kind of digital institution.

We will not build Tuneable to extract maximum value from music.

We will build it to return value to music.

We will not treat listeners as consumers and artists as suppliers. We will treat people as participants.

We will make it possible for people to display what they love, support what they believe in and champion what they think the world should hear.

We will make discovery social. We will make discovery geographical. We will allow musical language to evolve from the communities that use it. We will reward people for discovering and championing music early.

We will seek to put more value into the hands of creators and less into the machinery of the platform.

We will keep our economics visible. We will not secretly sell democratic influence. We will not allow commercial relationships to masquerade as community support.

We will progressively open our technology. We will progressively open our governance. We will protect individual privacy while making the system itself increasingly transparent.

We will not build a speculative token and call it a community. We will use technology in service of music, not music in service of technology.

We will constrain extraction. We will limit executive enrichment. We will build for the global music community, not merely the wealthiest markets.

And we will remember that our ultimate measure of success is not how much wealth Tuneable accumulates.

It is how much **music, creativity, connection, opportunity and community** Tuneable enables.

THE MUSIC COMMONS

The objective is not to own the music.

The objective is to help the people who make, discover and love it own more of its future.

Discover. Support. Champion. Participate.